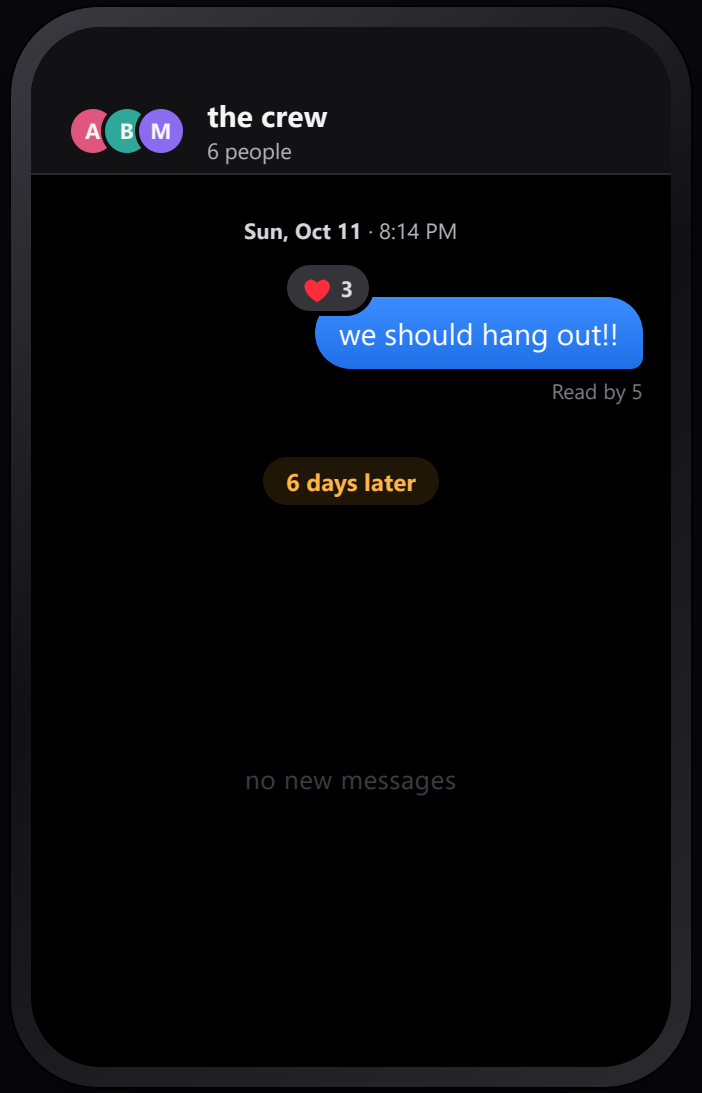


Whats the Word

Meet Homi, the friend in your group chat who makes plans happen. It never gets tired, and it forgets everything afterwards.

Team: {{TEAM}}

Built on Photon



THE PROBLEM

153 → 67

minutes a day with friends, in person · ages 15-24 · 2003 → 2019

Americans aged 15-24 spent 153 minutes a day with friends in person in 2003 — and 67 in 2019.

Source: Kannan & Veazie, SSM-Population Health 2023 (ATUS 2003-2020)

WHY IT KEEPS HAPPENING

01 **The organizer burns out.**

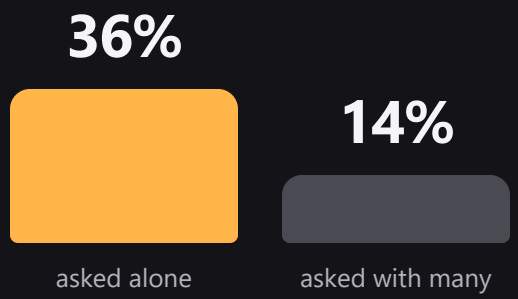
It's always the same person nudging, and they get tired of it.

02 **Silence reads as rejection.**

Nobody wants to be the one chasing the quiet friend.

03 **Tools leave the chat.**

Polls, calendar links and planning apps all send friends somewhere else.



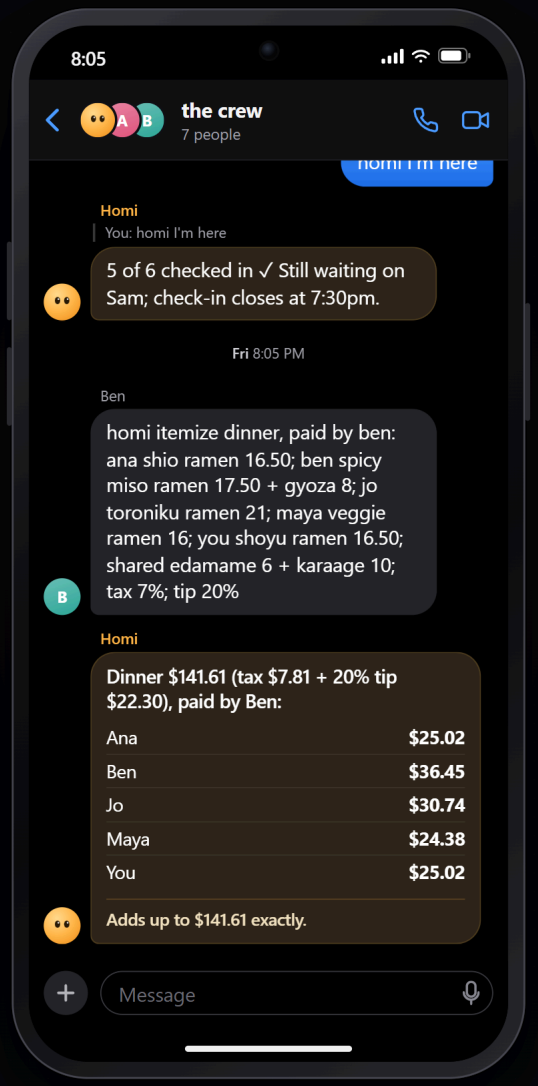
36% vs 14% reply when one vs many are asked (Blair et al. 2005).

Blair, Thompson & Wuensch, Basic & Applied Social Psychology 27(2), 2005: email field experiment, 400 participants. Shown as a mechanism, not a group-chat statistic.

THE INSIGHT

The fix has to live in the chat you already have, and carry the social cost so no human has to.

> **Nobody keeps their social life in a calendar.** Homi never asks for one.



06 · SPLIT THE BILL

Ben paid. Homi does the math.

LIVE DEMO

Watch for three things.

1. Hearts and plain replies like “anything but thu” both count as votes.
2. The quiet friend gets a short call from Homi, only because they opted in, and the group hears first.
3. After dinner: the bill, the pledge, the album, the next trip. Then ask what it knows, and tell it to forget.

Video: phone mock-up of the flow (2.5 min). Call audio and pledge payments are simulated; trip prices are estimates.

AFTER THE PLAN

Split it, pledge it, keep it, go further.

Split the bill

Itemized receipts, shared plates, tax and tip by share. It adds up to the cent, then says who pays whom across every payer.

IN THE APP Math only. No money moves.

Show-up pledge

Optional $10 each, back when you check in. Nothing is held until everyone agrees where no-show money goes; disputes go to a vote.

SIMULATED Every deposit, refund and forfeit is labeled SIMULATED. Real payments need a provider integration.

Shared album

Photos go to an album only the group can open. Anyone can remove their own, and it stays until the group deletes it.

DEMO LINK Album flow in the app; real photo hosting needs integration.

Plan the trip

Itinerary and a per-person budget, a comfort upgrade with the price difference explained, and the savings people miss.

ESTIMATES Example listings, estimated prices. Live fares and booking need integration.

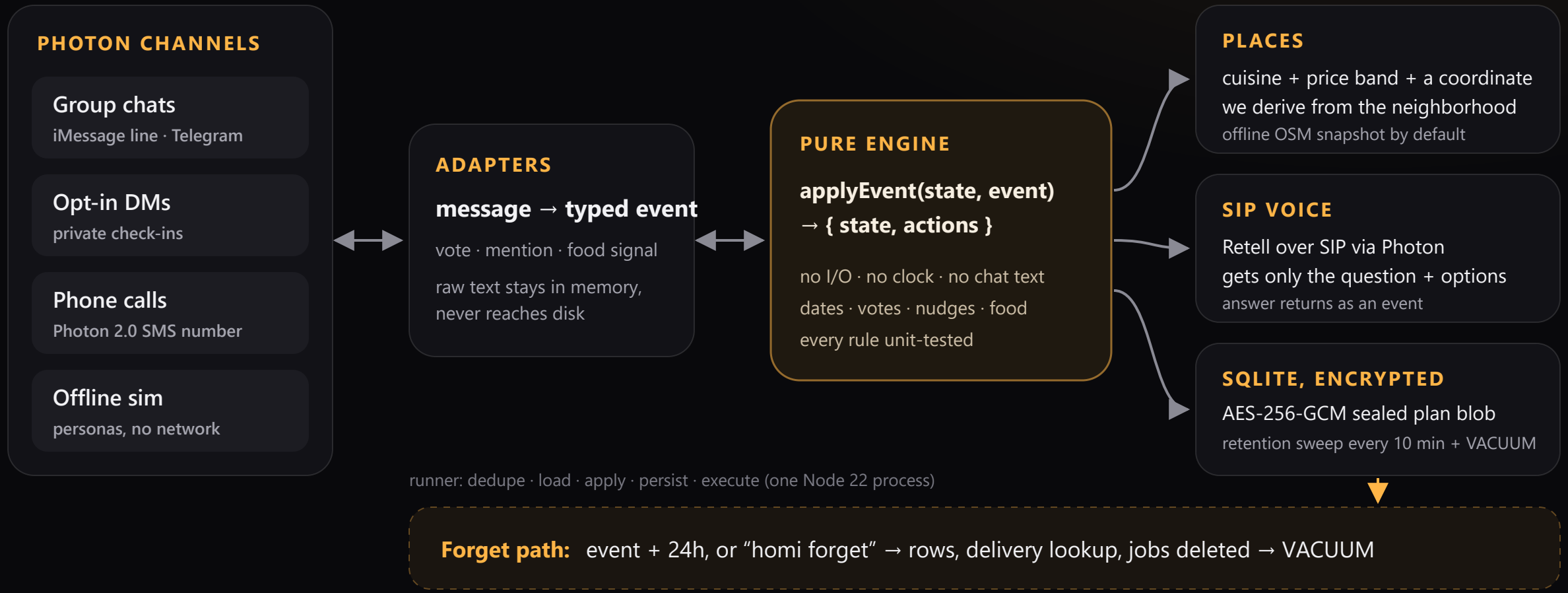
PRIVACY BY DESIGN

Ask it what it knows. Tell it to forget.

- It stores the plan, never the conversation: no table can hold message text.
- Everything personal is encrypted at rest, and logs scrub names and numbers.
- It never asks where you are: one typed neighborhood, kept with the plan.
- It deletes everything 24 hours after the event, or now with `homi forget`.
- DMs and calls only reach people who opted in, and the group is always told.

HOW IT WORKS

Thin adapters, a pure engine, and a store that forgets.



WHAT WE MEASURED & WHAT'S NEXT

Measured on labeled conversations, honest about the rest.

Date replies read correctly	98.5%
Right final date	10 / 10
Food-intent precision / recall	100% / 87.9%
Noise budget + quiet hours kept	10 / 10
Message text or numbers in logs / DB	0 / 0
Place matched cuisine + budget	3 / 4*

10 role-play group chats (183 labeled messages), written blind from our spec by a separate author that never saw the code · npm run eval · *the map has no Thai near Harvard Sq

What is simulated: the call audio and the pledge payments in the demo video, and the chat personas in the offline simulator. Restaurants come from a bundled OpenStreetMap snapshot; prices and trip costs are estimates.

NEXT

1. **More channels**
   WhatsApp, RCS and SMS through Photon 2.0.
2. **Interactive iMessage cards**
   Tap-to-vote cards instead of option bubbles.
3. **Open-source release**
   So any group can audit exactly what Homi stores.